

GS Prelims cum Mains Self Study Plan 2025

Indian Polity and Governance

Polity Self-Study Roadmap:

- **Understand the Syllabus**
 - Know the Topics: Familiarize yourself with the syllabus for both prelims and mains.
 - Key areas include the Constitution of India, fundamental rights and duties, directive principles of state policy, executive, legislature, judiciary, and other political institutions.
- **Refer to Basic Books and Resources:**
 - NCERT Books: Start with Class 9 to 12 NCERT textbooks on Political Science.
 - Laxmikanth's 'Indian Polity': This is the most recommended book for polity and covers almost all topics in the syllabus.
- **Reference Books:**
 - DD Basu's 'Introduction to the Constitution of India'
 - Subhash Kashyap's 'Our Constitution' and 'Our Parliament'
- **Current Affairs:**
 - Newspapers: The Hindu, The Indian Express
 - Magazines: Yojana, Kurukshetra, and monthly current affairs magazines.
- **Follow Study Plan Consistently**
 - Daily Schedule: Dedicate specific hours each day to study polity. Balance your time between reading textbooks, making notes, and solving questions.
 - Weekly Targets: Set weekly goals to cover particular chapters or topics.
 - Revision: Regular revision is crucial. Revise notes and key concepts periodically.
- **Make Comprehensive Notes**
 - Summarize Chapters: Make concise notes from NCERTs and Laxmikanth. Highlight key points, articles, amendments, and case laws.
 - Current Affairs Integration: Integrate current affairs with your notes. For example, add recent Supreme Court judgments, bills passed, or significant political developments.
 - Flowcharts and Diagrams: Use flowcharts, diagrams, and tables to make your notes more visual and easier to remember.

- **Focus on Key Areas**

- Read the Bare Act: Go through the bare text of the Indian Constitution to understand the exact language and provisions.
- Important Articles: Focus on key articles, such as Article 14-32 (Fundamental Rights), Article 36-51 (Directive Principles), and Articles 74, 75, 124, 148, 280, etc.
- Fundamental Rights and Duties: Understand the rights provided to citizens, their scope, and limitations.
- Directive Principles: Study their purpose, classification, and their role in governance.
- Executive, Legislature, and Judiciary: Learn about their structure, powers, and functions.
- Amendments: Know significant constitutional amendments and their impact.
- Important Cases: Study landmark Supreme Court judgments, such as Kesavananda Bharati, Golaknath, Minerva Mills, etc.

- **Solve Previous Year Papers and Mock Tests**

- Previous Year Papers: Solve at least 10 years of previous year's UPSC prelims and mains question papers to understand the pattern and frequently asked questions.
- Mock Tests: Regularly take mock tests to assess your preparation, identify weaknesses, and improve time management.

- **Regularly Update Yourself**

- Current Developments: Stay updated with current political events, government policies, and recent Supreme Court judgments.
- Government Websites: Refer to official websites like the Press Information Bureau (PIB), Ministry of Law and Justice, and PRS Legislative Research for authentic information.

- **Refer to Online Content**

- YouTube Channels: offering free lectures
- Online Forums: Telegram, Free content websites

- **Healthy Study Habits:**

- Maintain a healthy study routine with regular breaks.
- Stay physically active and manage stress effectively.

Week 1 Day 1

Topic	Subtopic	Source	Important Topics
1. Historical Background 2. Making of the constitution	• The Company Rule (1773–1858) • The Crown Rule (1858–1947) • Demand for a Constituent Assembly • Composition of the Constituent Assembly • Working of the Constituent Assembly • Committees of the Constituent Assembly • Enactment of the Constitution • Enforcement of the Constitution • Experts Committee of the Congress • Criticism of the Constituent Assembly • Important Facts • Hindi Text of the Constitution	NCERT • Class 9 Democratic Politics 1 (Chapter 1,2,3) Reference Book • M. Laxmikanth (Chapter 1,2, 3)	• The Company Rule (1773–1858): Key Provisions • The Crown Rule (1858–1947): Key Provisions • Composition of the Constituent Assembly: Formation and Members and Representation • Working of the Constituent Assembly • Committees of the Constituent Assembly with Leaders • Enactment of the Constitution: Provisions, Timeline, Significance • Enforcement of the Constitution
Daily Objective Test	On the topics covered as per daily schedule		
Current Affairs	National and International	The Hindu, Indian Express	• Refer Suggestions below

Current Affairs Suggested Reads:

Historical Background:

- Commemorations: 75th Independence anniversary and key historical events.
- Colonial Legacies: Impact of colonial laws on modern governance.
- Biographies/Documentaries: Focus on key historical figures and events.

Making of the Constitution:

- Constitutional Reforms: Ongoing and proposed amendments.
- Judicial Interpretations: Supreme Court judgments on constitutional provisions.
- Public Awareness Campaigns: Initiatives for Constitution Day.

Week 1 Day 2

Topic	Subtopic	Source	Important Topics
1. Salient Features of the Constitution 2. Preamble of the Constitution	- Salient Features of the Constitution - Criticism of the Constitution - Text of the Preamble - Ingredients of the Preamble - Key Words in the Preamble - Significance of the Preamble - Preamble as Part of the Constitution - Amendability of the Preamble	NCERT - Class 9 Democratic Politics 1 (Chapter 4,5,6) Reference Book M. Laxmikanth (Chapter 4, 5)	- Salient Features of the Constitution: Key Features - Criticism of the Constitution - Text of the Preamble: Definition of Key Concepts like Sovereign, Secular etc. - Ingredients of the Preamble - Key Words in the Preamble - Significance of the Preamble: - Preamble as Part of the Constitution: Judgements and current status - Amendability of the Preamble: Judgements and current status
Daily Objective Test	On the topics covered as per daily schedule		
Current Affairs	National and International	The Hindu, Indian Express	Refer Suggestions below

Current Affairs Suggested Reads:

Salient Features of the Constitution:

- Federalism and Unitarism: Current debates on Centre-State relations and autonomy.
- Amendments: Recent or proposed changes impacting constitutional features.
- Rights and Duties: Discussion on the balance and implementation of fundamental rights and duties.

Preamble of the Constitution:

- Liberty and Freedom: Recent cases and policies affecting individual freedoms.
- Equality: Initiatives and challenges in achieving social and economic equality.
- Constitutional Values: Public campaigns promoting the values enshrined in the Preamble.

Week 1 Day 3

Topic	Subtopic	Source	Important Topics
1. Union and its Territory 2. Citizenship	• Union of States • Parliament's Power to Reorganise the States • Exchange of Territories with Bangladesh • Evolution of States and Union Territories • Citizenship Meaning and Significance • Constitutional Provisions • Citizenship Act, 1955 • Single Citizenship • Overseas Citizenship of India	NCERT • Class 10 Democratic Politics 2 (Chapter 1,2) Reference Book • M. Laxmikanth (Chapter 6, 7)	• Union of States: Article 1 • Parliament's Power to Reorganise the States: Article 2 & 3, President's power • Evolution of States and Union Territories: States Reorganisation Act, 1956, Timeline and recent states formation • Citizenship Meaning and Significance • Constitutional Provisions: Articles 5 to 11 • Citizenship Act, 1955: Key provisions • Single Citizenship: Comparison with federal countries having dual citizenship
Daily Objective Test	On the topics covered as per daily schedule		
Current Affairs	National and International	The Hindu, Indian Express	Refer Suggestions below

Current Affairs Suggested Reads:

Union and its Territory:

- State Reorganization
- Special Status: Issues related to special provisions for states like Jammu & Kashmir.
- Territorial Disputes: India-China and India-Pakistan border issues.

Citizenship:

- Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA)
- National Register of Citizens (NRC)
- Dual Citizenship: Discussions on Overseas Citizenship of India (OCI).

Week 1 Day 4

Topic	Subtopic	Source	Important Topics
1. Amendment of the constitution 2. Basic structure of the constitution	● Procedure for Amendment ● Types of Amendments ● Criticism of the Amendment Procedure ● Emergence of the Basic Structure ● Elements of the Basic Structure	NCERT ● Class 11 Indian Constitution at Work, (Chapter 1,2) Reference Book ● M. Laxmikanth (Chapter 11, 12)	● Procedure for Amendment: Article 368 and provisions ● Types of Amendments: Difference in Types of majority- Special, Effective, Simple etc ● Criticism of the Amendment Procedure: Balance of rigidity vs flexibility, various arguments of Personalities ● Emergence of the Basic Structure: Judicial Interpretations ● Elements of the Basic Structure: list components that have been recognised as part of this
Daily Objective Test	On the topics covered as per daily schedule		
Current Affairs	National and International	The Hindu, Indian Express	Refer Suggestions below

Current Affairs Suggested Reads:

Amendment of the Constitution:

- Recent Amendments: Analysis and impact of the latest constitutional amendments.
- Judicial Review: Supreme Court cases evaluating amendment validity.

Basic Structure of the Constitution:

- Landmark Judgments: Supreme Court rulings reinforcing the basic structure doctrine.
- Challenges to Basic Structure: Contemporary legal cases testing the doctrine.
- Scholarly Debates: Academic discussions on the evolution and scope of the basic structure.

Week 1 Day 5

Topic	Subtopic	Source	Important Topics
1. Fundamental Rights	- Features of Fundamental Rights - Definition of State - Laws Inconsistent with Fundamental Rights - Right to Equality - Right to Freedom	NCERT - Class 11 Indian Constitution at Work, (Chapter 3) Reference Book M. Laxmikanth (Chapter 8)	- Features of Fundamental Rights: In depth reading with exceptions, Judgements, Special provisions etc, comparison with other countries- USA, UK etc - Definition of State - Laws Inconsistent with Fundamental Rights: Judicial pronouncements - Right to Equality - Right to Freedom
Daily Objective Test	On the topics covered as per daily schedule		
Current Affairs	National and International	The Hindu, Indian Express	Refer Suggestions below

Current Affairs Suggested Reads:

Fundamental Rights in Recent Years in India

- Right to Privacy: Supreme Court ruling recognizing privacy as a fundamental right.
- Freedom of Expression: Debates on free speech limitations, social media regulations, and hate speech laws.
- Right to Equality: Legal battles for gender equality, including women's entry to religious places and LGBTQ+ rights.
- Right to Education: Implementation and challenges of the Right to Education Act.
- Environmental Rights: Judicial activism on pollution control and sustainable development.
- Rights of the Accused: Reforms in custodial rights, fair trial, and anti-torture laws.
- Digital Rights: Data protection laws and rights concerning digital privacy and cyber security

Week 1 Day 6

Topic	Subtopic	Source	Important Topics
1. Fundamental Rights	● Right Against Exploitation ● Right to Freedom of Religion ● Cultural and Educational Rights ● Right to Constitutional Remedies ● Writs—Types and Scope ● Armed Forces and Fundamental Rights ● Martial Law and Fundamental Rights	NCERT ● Class 11 Indian Constitution at Work, (Chapter 4) Reference Book ● M. Laxmikanth (Chapter 8)	● Right Against Exploitation ● Right to Freedom of Religion ● Cultural and Educational Rights ● Right to Constitutional Remedies ● Writs—Types and Scope ● Armed Forces and Fundamental Rights ● Martial Law and Fundamental Rights
Daily Objective Test	On the topics covered as per daily schedule		
Current Affairs	National and International	The Hindu, Indian Express	Refer Suggestions below

Current Affairs Suggested Reads:

Fundamental Rights in Recent Years in India

- Right to Privacy: Supreme Court ruling recognizing privacy as a fundamental right.
- Freedom of Expression: Debates on free speech limitations, social media regulations, and hate speech laws.
- Right to Equality: Legal battles for gender equality, including women's entry to religious places and LGBTQ+ rights.
- Right to Education: Implementation and challenges of the Right to Education Act.
- Environmental Rights: Judicial activism on pollution control and sustainable development.
- Rights of the Accused: Reforms in custodial rights, fair trial, and anti-torture laws.
- Digital Rights: Data protection laws and rights concerning digital privacy and cyber security

Week 1 Day 7

Topic	Subtopic	Source	Important Topics
WEEKLY REVISION	• Historical Background • Making of the constitution • Salient Features of the Constitution • Preamble of the Constitution • Union and its Territory • Citizenship • Amendment of the constitution • Basic structure of the constitution • Fundamental Rights	NCERT • Class 9,10,11 Democratic Politics, Indian Constitution at Work, (Chapter 1-5) Reference Book • M. Laxmikanth (Chapter 1-8, 11, 12)	All Important topics
Weekly Objective Test	On the topics covered as per weekly schedule		
Current Affairs	Revision of Important Current Affairs		

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